

BOB INGRAM



TERWILLIGER

EL Paso gets 'Twig' from Brooklyn 'Tree'

AS A QUICK and nimble second baseman who made the pivot on double plays about as fast as it's ever been made in the majors, Wayne Terwilliger was a member of three big league clubs that were later relocated.

He was with the Brooklyn Dodgers who were moved to Los Angeles. He played for the Washington Senators who became the Minnesota Twins and he was with the Kansas City A's who moved to Oakland and became first the pride of Charles Finley and then a thorn in his side.

Also, going a little further, Terwilliger coached for Ted Williams when he managed a new edition of the Washington Senators. They were also relocated to Texas and became the Rangers.

The manager of the Tulsa Drillers who are here now playing El Paso Diablos is nicknamed "Twig." Maybe it's a derivation of his name or maybe it had its origination from the fact that he was with Brooklyn Dodgers when the book, "A Tree Grows in Brooklyn," was current.

Terwilliger is a little pepper pot of a manager whose weight hasn't changed from his playing days when it was 165. He's a little older of course and probably comes under the status of an old time manager. It seems like every baseball man who has any age on him knows Andy Cohen. Terwilliger played for Charleston against Denver when Andy was managing the latter club in the American Association. So, he greeted his old adversary here this week.

"Twig" brought his Tulsa team to El Paso basking in a seven-game winning streak. The Diablos broke the Drillers' charm with a 9-6 win Tuesday night.

BUT STREAKS come and go with Terwilliger. When he was with the Kansas City A's they streaked all the way to third place on an 11-game winning string. Then the club proceeded to lose 13 in a row before they could get the gates to the cellar closed.

The "Twig" hit only 22 homers in his major league career. The two he selects as his best remembered were hit off two of the most storied pitchers in the majors—Whitey Ford of the Yankees and Don Newcombe of the Dodgers.

Recalling the homer off Ford, the "Twig" said he was reminded that day by another player that Whitey was really effective with a slider. So, when "Twig" went up to bat he looked for that pitch and got it on Whitey's first offering. He lifted the ball into the left field seats.

The two big events in Terwilliger's big league career were against his teams.

One was Bobby Thompson's historic homer that won the National League pennant for the New York Giants in 1951.

"Twig" was in the Brooklyn dugout in that game which was a playoff to decide the pennant. "I was counting my money," he said. "I figured the Dodgers were going to be in the World Series and I would get at least \$5,000 for my part of the Series cut."

The Dodgers were winning the game until Thompson came up in the ninth and got the homer that gave the Giants a 5-4 win and the flag.

Then Terwilliger was in the Washington Senators' dugout the day Mickey Vernon may have hit the longest home run in history. It was a tape measured 563-foot homer that with the ball going so high it was lost in the clouds momentarily.

THE TULSA man's favorite in baseball may be Ted Williams with whom he was associated for three seasons. He was Williams' coach at both Washington and at Texas. He speaks of the one or baseball's Hall of Famers with revered tones.

"He would help anyone who had a batting problem," said Terwilliger. "That included our players or players of the team we were playing. Nellie Fox was on our coaching staff and I remember him telling Ted that he was going too far in trying to help players who would use the information to try and beat us."

Williams didn't have very good clubs either at Washington or Texas, but the "Twig" says he did an outstanding job of handling his pitchers.

"We were in last place and went to Baltimore for a series," Terwilliger recalls. "Baltimore was in first place. We beat the Orioles four straight games."

That was a good enough way for Terwilliger to make his exit from the majors. He's been managing in the minors for some 15 years. This is his first trip in the Texas League. He's looking forward to playing in a new Tulsa park which is now being finished and will be ready before the season ends.

Terwilliger is from Clare, Mich., the cold country.

In the "Baseball Register" of 1969, his hobby is listed as ice fishing.

I would like to warn him that ice fishing on the Rio Grande here is out of season and that he will be subject to a heavy fine if he does any of it on this trip, which is the only one the Drillers will make to El Paso this season.

Troop regroups for Lubbock

By BRUCE WILLIAMS

The story sounds familiar: Eastwood's baseball team is one game down with two to go. The Troopers must win two straight to avoid having their season come to an end.

Yet a comeback this time is going to be a lot tougher than it was against Austin a week ago in the bi-district playoffs. This time, the Troop must fight back against a young and powerful Lubbock Coronado squad which will have the home field — and even the home town — advantage in both remaining games of the regional playoffs.

Not only must the Troopers fight a tough opponent in a strange land, but they must contend with another rival which proved deadly in the series opener Wednesday at Dudley Field: themselves. Five Eastwood errors and untimely walks proved disastrous as Coronado came away with a 7-4 win in the first game of the best-of-three series.

While Eastwood was allowing six unearned runs, the Lubbock defense was supporting pitcher Dean Jackson with errorless play. That gave the left-hander, now 11-1 for the season, a big psychological edge.

"THEY'RE BEHIND ME all the time," Jackson said in appreciation of his mates. "I know I've got good support on defense, and that makes my job a lot easier. Today I was just throwing a curveball, then the fast-ball; they (the Troopers) didn't hit it very well — not like they said they'd hit it."



SAFELY INTO SECOND goes Eastwood's Carlos Apodaca (16) with a stolen base in the second inning of his team's regional baseball game with Lubbock Coronado Wednesday at

Dudley Field. Apodaca got two hits, and RBI and scored once, but that wasn't enough to avoid a 7-4 loss. Donald Ewing is the Coronado player covering the base.

"That's the way it's seemed to be all year. I throw that slow curve, and they usually seem to hit it on the ground right at someone or pop it up."

Winning Coach John Dudley also had plenty of praise for his ace and the Mustang defense. "Against Monterey (in the district playoff) we played real good this way. Probably the best defense we've shown all year long has been in the playoffs. (The

Troopers) hit the ball basically where we expected them to.

"They hit him (Jackson) real hard, harder than he's been hit. And that pitcher of theirs (Mike Ross) showed us a fastball more than we thought he would; we didn't hit most of the game. Outside of the errors we would have been in trouble."

Ross did look fantastic at times.

(Continued on Page C-3)